

Case Study: UPI / Online Payment Fraud

1. What is the crime?

UPI (Unified Payments Interface) fraud is a rapidly increasing cybercrime in India, where individuals are tricked into authorizing fraudulent digital transactions without realizing it. With the growing use of apps like Google Pay and PhonePe, scammers are taking advantage of users' lack of awareness and trust in digital systems.

2. How does it typically happen (step-by-step)?

1. A victim receives a call or message on platforms like WhatsApp.
 2. The scammer pretends to be a buyer, bank official, or customer support agent.
 3. They create urgency by mentioning refunds, offers, or account-related issues.
 4. A payment request or QR code is sent to the victim.
 5. The victim is falsely told that entering the UPI PIN is required to receive money.
 6. Once the PIN is entered, money is instantly deducted from the account.
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3. Who is usually targeted?

This type of fraud mainly targets students, elderly individuals, and first-time digital payment users. People who are unaware or in a hurry are more likely to fall victim.

4. What are the consequences?

Victims may suffer immediate financial loss, emotional stress, and loss of trust in online systems. In some cases, repeated scams can lead to serious financial problems.

5. Conclusion

This case highlights the importance of digital literacy. Being cautious and informed can help individuals avoid such scams and stay safe in the digital world.